Market Brief - offline copy

Snapshot taken Monday 26 October 2026, 18:13 (Europe/Madrid). Data is frozen at that time. Links open the original articles when you are online.

Daily overview

Markets over the last day: the eight tracked equity indices moved +0.61% on average, with Nasdaq strongest (+1.07%) and Nikkei 225 weakest (-0.34%). Brent crude changed -4.54% to 111.42. Gold changed +0.69% to 4,035.7. Bitcoin changed +0.44% to 80,372.2578. The US 10-year yield stands at 4.982%, a relative move of -0.12%. Among the firms tracked, Vale (-3.47%) and Santander (-3.44%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: Bon Secours agrees $5.7bn takeover of Bain-backed Surgery Partners (FT Markets). US hospital chain is the latest not-for-profit healthcare provider to strike a large deal Deals and capital markets: Anthropic begins countdown to IPO with prospectus filing (FT Markets). 240,000-word prospectus lays out explosive growth alongside steep losses and daunting risk factors Geopolitics and trade: Singapore to store Saudi Arabian oil in caverns (FT Markets). Agreement with Saudi Aramco aims to secure energy supplies for south-east Asia amid Middle East war disruption Also ranking highly: Marc Lore's Wonder bets on Texas, automation and user-built restaurants as it mulls IPO (CNBC). Wonder is leaning into automation and user-built restaurants as founder Marc Lore prepares the startup for a potential IPO. Also ranking highly: Survey on the Access to Finance of Enterprises: lending conditions tightened (ECB). Also ranking highly: Frank Elderson: Taking action for nature – investing in economic resilience and prosperity (ECB).

Weekly overview

Markets over the past seven days: the eight tracked equity indices moved -1.03% on average, with Dow Jones strongest (+0.73%) and Nikkei 225 weakest (-4.03%). Brent crude changed +1.71% to 111.42. Gold changed -2.99% to 4,035.7. Bitcoin changed -4.33% to 80,372.2578. The US 10-year yield stands at 4.982%, a relative move of -3.00%. Among the firms tracked, Blackstone (+9.92%) and Vale (-8.70%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: Buyout firm EQT acquires German diagnostics group in €10.8bn deal (FT Markets). Move for Germany's Qiagen is one of the largest take-private transactions in Europe this year Deals and capital markets: How a transatlantic mega-merger fell apart over a leadership tug of war (FT Companies). Smith & Nephew was in talks to combine with J&J's orthopaedics unit but refused to agree to former CEO leading combined business Central banks and macro: Israeli central bank rejects Netanyahu's plan to use crypto to evade sanctions (FT World). Critics say prime minister's proposal would turn country into an economic pariah Central banks and macro: UK September inflation fuels expectations of imminent BoE rate rise (FT World). Headline and core inflation accelerates ahead of November meeting Geopolitics and trade: Iran war sparks heating crisis in US north-east as winter approaches (FT Markets). Record heating oil prices are forcing the region to rethink prior opposition to natural gas pipelines

Major news by sector (past 7 days)

IPOs & Listings

Microsoft gives data centre hopefuls a pre-IPO reality check

FT Companies | 20 Oct 06:00

The US tech giant calling time on its Nscale deal exposes faultlines running through this fast-growing area of the AI sector

Ambani looks to pull off India's biggest IPO

FT Markets | 20 Oct 02:33

Jio Platforms aims to list at $107bn valuation amid stock market downturn, tougher competition and goading from Elon Musk

Anthropic begins countdown to IPO with prospectus filing

FT Markets | 26 Oct 15:41

240,000-word prospectus lays out explosive growth alongside steep losses and daunting risk factors

CVC explores bid for Verisure just one year after IPO

FT Markets | 21 Oct 19:43

Shares in Swedish-listed security group trading 30% below their price at flotation

Marc Lore's Wonder bets on Texas, automation and user-built restaurants as it mulls IPO

CNBC | 26 Oct 13:49

Wonder is leaning into automation and user-built restaurants as founder Marc Lore prepares the startup for a potential IPO.

Waiting for good IPO

FT Markets | 20 Oct 07:30

Anthropic's shrinking window to list

M&A & Deals

Buyout firm EQT acquires German diagnostics group in €10.8bn deal

FT Markets | 22 Oct 00:23

Move for Germany's Qiagen is one of the largest take-private transactions in Europe this year

How a transatlantic mega-merger fell apart over a leadership tug of war

FT Companies | 23 Oct 17:56

Smith & Nephew was in talks to combine with J&J's orthopaedics unit but refused to agree to former CEO leading combined business

Bon Secours agrees $5.7bn takeover of Bain-backed Surgery Partners

FT Markets | 26 Oct 15:08

US hospital chain is the latest not-for-profit healthcare provider to strike a large deal

Big private equity backers call for greater scrutiny of sweetheart deals

FT Markets | 22 Oct 06:00

Concern that investors are insufficiently prepared to challenge buyout firms on deals involving potential conflicts

Nestlé removes Russian business from accounts after Kremlin takeover

FT World | 22 Oct 09:55

Swiss group takes $1.95bn net assets from its balance sheet after presidential decree to control business

Musk sets lower sales target for Tesla as it explores SpaceX merger

FT Companies | 22 Oct 01:30

Carmaker reports flat revenue and falling profits as it pivots from electric vehicles to AI

Private Equity, VC & Angels

Could Anthropic's IPO be a turning point for AI? You asked, we answered

FT Markets | 22 Oct 17:00

Tech writer at large Richard Waters and venture capital correspondent George Hammond replied to reader questions

New York pensions chief says private equity firm sought to expense jet use

FT Markets | 19 Oct 23:18

Head of city's $326bn Retirement Systems hits out at 'steady creep' higher in fees charged by managers

Banking

Goldman Sachs, JPMorgan and Morgan Stanley are dominating the AI stock boom. Here's their edge

CNBC | 21 Oct 17:30

Wall Street’s Big Three have generated $52 billion in equity trading revenue this year, capturing about 80% of the market on rising margin lending to hedge funds.

Central Banks & Macro

Israeli central bank rejects Netanyahu’s plan to use crypto to evade sanctions

FT World | 24 Oct 21:19

Critics say prime minister’s proposal would turn country into an economic pariah

UK September inflation fuels expectations of imminent BoE rate rise

FT World | 21 Oct 09:03

Headline and core inflation accelerates ahead of November meeting

UK inflation and borrowing top forecasts in blow to Healey

FT World | 21 Oct 18:31

Figure comes ahead of next week’s Budget and will cement expectations of Bank of England rate rise in November

ECB on course for another rate rise in 2026

FT World | 22 Oct 15:30

Read the October scenario by the FT’s Monetary Policy Radar team

Hungary detains Orbán’s former central bank chief

FT World | 21 Oct 14:39

György Matolcsy and several others arrested in corruption probes targeting former PM’s circle of power

Turkey cuts interest rates despite $18bn investment funds scandal

FT World | 22 Oct 15:06

Central bank lowers benchmark rate to 36% as inflation eases

Geopolitics & Trade

Iran war sparks heating crisis in US north-east as winter approaches

FT Markets | 21 Oct 12:00

Record heating oil prices are forcing the region to rethink prior opposition to natural gas pipelines

Singapore to store Saudi Arabian oil in caverns

FT Markets | 26 Oct 07:57

Agreement with Saudi Aramco aims to secure energy supplies for south-east Asia amid Middle East war disruption

The right’s obsession with ‘civil war’ in Britain

FT World | 25 Oct 06:00

Many of those stoking fears of bloody unrest don’t actually live in the country

The limits of Trump’s trade war

FT Home | 23 Oct 06:00

Economies like Mexico are being forced to choose sides on trade

Tehran’s cafés offer a brief escape from war and economic crisis

FT Companies | 23 Oct 06:00

Middle-class residents push back against social restrictions with some cafés even defying the ban on alcohol

Are we sleepwalking into a third world war?

FT World | 22 Oct 06:00

FT foreign editor Alec Russell speaks to Gideon Rachman about his new book

Markets

Equities	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,683.73	+0.79%	-0.09%
Nasdaq	26,232.9414	+1.07%	-0.75%
Dow Jones	52,345.3594	+0.25%	+0.73%
FTSE 100	10,767.3301	+0.72%	+0.02%
DAX	25,410.8398	+0.91%	+0.36%
Nikkei 225	62,693.1602	-0.34%	-4.03%
Hang Seng	23,093.3691	+0.69%	-4.03%
Euro Stoxx 50	6,116.23	+0.79%	-0.47%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1192	-0.26%	-0.29%
GBP/USD	1.3351	-0.40%	+0.11%
USD/JPY	157.438	+0.60%	-0.23%
USD/CNY	6.6583	-0.29%	-0.49%

Bonds	Last	Day	Week
US 5Y yield	4.819	+0.29%	-2.23%
US 10Y yield	4.982	-0.12%	-3.00%
US 30Y yield	5.296	-0.36%	-3.22%

Financial sector	Last	Day	Week
US Financials (XLF)	56.06	+0.29%	+1.82%
US Banks (KBE)	66.2725	+0.61%	+4.99%
Europe Financials (EUFN)	38.07	+0.93%	-0.13%

Energy	Last	Day	Week
Brent crude	111.42	-4.54%	+1.71%
WTI crude	102.38	-0.86%	-1.23%
Natural gas	3.048	+15.45%	-0.33%

Metals	Last	Day	Week
Gold	4,035.7	+0.69%	-2.99%
Silver	54.235	+0.98%	-4.81%
Copper	6.5455	+1.07%	+0.11%

Agriculture	Last	Day	Week

Wheat	616.75	-1.32%	-5.88%
Corn	455.25	-0.16%	-2.52%
Soybeans	1,250.5	-0.48%	-0.24%
Coffee	300.15	-2.37%	-4.93%

Crypto	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Bitcoin	80,372.2578	+0.44%	-4.33%
Ethereum	2,329.04	+0.09%	-5.74%

Investment Banks	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Goldman Sachs	897.13	+2.45%	+2.44%
Morgan Stanley	184.64	+2.87%	+3.46%
JPMorgan	334.81	+0.97%	+0.38%
Bank of America	50.865	+0.60%	+0.94%
Citigroup	121.955	+1.11%	+0.22%
UBS	46.675	+0.66%	-0.67%
Deutsche Bank	32.085	+2.84%	+1.44%
Barclays	22.33	+2.71%	+0.72%
HSBC	91.47	+0.87%	-1.60%
Santander	12.3989	-3.44%	-4.77%
BBVA	25.445	+2.27%	+0.77%
Lazard	37.89	+1.83%	+6.40%
Evercore	259.145	+2.88%	+4.51%
Jefferies	45.7	+2.03%	+4.82%

Asset Managers & Private Equity	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
BlackRock	1,130.865	+1.13%	+0.56%
Blackstone	117.71	-0.22%	+9.92%
KKR	91.73	+0.43%	+5.44%
Apollo	115.66	+2.51%	+4.25%
Carlyle	38.695	+0.27%	+5.84%
Ares Management	121.795	-0.23%	+7.78%
T. Rowe Price	104.52	+0.31%	+4.42%
Franklin Templeton	31.345	+0.92%	+2.07%
Invesco	28.685	+2.23%	+1.40%
3i Group	2,371.0	+2.60%	-0.88%
Schroders	589.0	+0.00%	+0.08%
Amundi	88.6	+1.61%	+1.08%
EQT	302.4	+1.00%	+2.34%

Exchanges & Payments	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Intercontinental Exchange	160.82	-1.18%	+1.53%
CME Group	307.785	+0.68%	+4.86%
Nasdaq Inc.	103.76	+1.17%	+11.33%

LSEG	9,340.0	-1.79%	+7.33%
Deutsche Boerse	314.3	+0.06%	+2.14%
Visa	403.805	-1.01%	+0.22%
Mastercard	613.22	-1.66%	-0.52%

Oil & Gas Majors	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
ExxonMobil	184.15	+0.51%	+3.29%
Chevron	232.6	-0.26%	+3.67%
Shell	107.39	-0.73%	+2.45%
BP	50.755	-1.10%	+2.66%
TotalEnergies	93.87	+1.17%	+4.36%
ConocoPhillips	151.59	+0.52%	+4.37%
Equinor	48.405	-0.85%	+4.89%
Occidental	64.155	-0.02%	+2.29%
US Oil Fund (ETF)	167.29	-1.32%	+4.03%

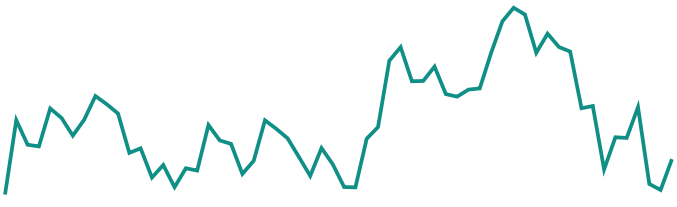
Mining & Metals	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
BHP	78.99	+1.46%	-5.08%
Rio Tinto	83.8	+0.46%	-6.37%
Glencore	538.1	+0.11%	-4.56%
Freeport-McMoRan	65.13	-0.08%	-6.62%
Newmont	109.395	+0.48%	-7.30%
Vale	11.97	-3.47%	-8.70%
Gold Miners (ETF)	81.23	+1.28%	-6.06%

Big Tech & IPO Barometer	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Nvidia	216.16	+2.46%	-0.43%
Microsoft	530.62	+1.16%	-0.54%
Apple	344.22	-1.01%	+0.37%
Amazon	249.48	+0.60%	-4.94%
Alphabet	318.865	-0.42%	-7.36%
Meta	641.0396	-0.25%	-9.13%
Tesla	396.75	+6.59%	+7.79%
Renaissance IPO (ETF)	48.99	+1.30%	-0.14%

Key charts (last 60 trading days)

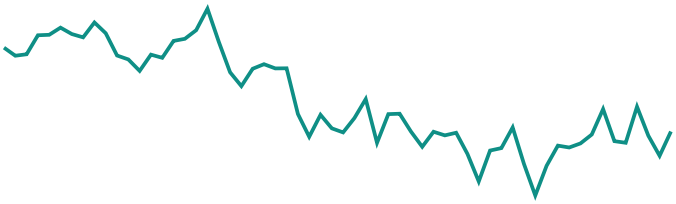
S&P 500: low 7551.81, high 7818.93, last 7683.73

Nasdaq: low 25913.9, high 27599.8, last 26232.9

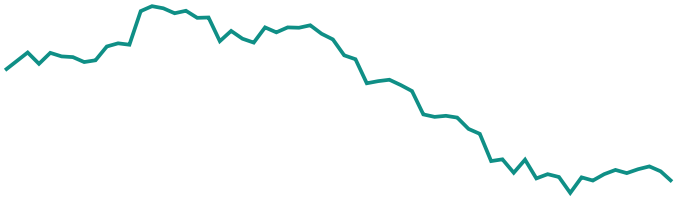


FTSE 100: low 10428.3, high 10901.1, last 10767.3

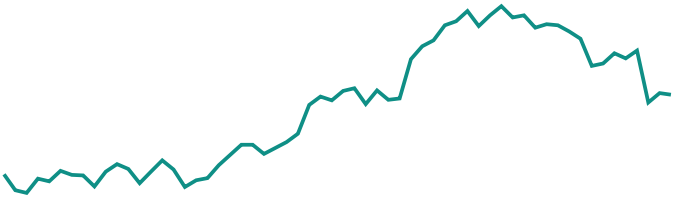
DAX: low 24807, high 26570, last 25410.8



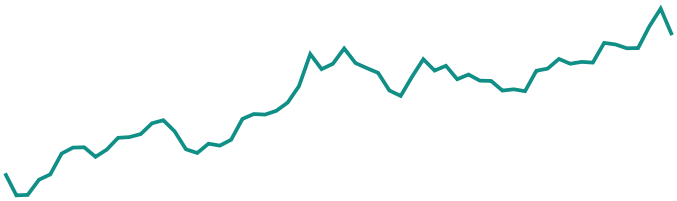
EUR/USD: low 1.116, high 1.1688, last 1.1192



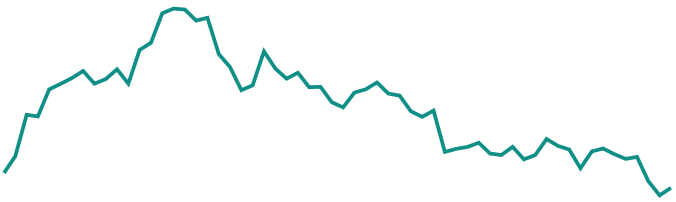
US 10Y yield: low 4.617, high 5.311, last 4.982

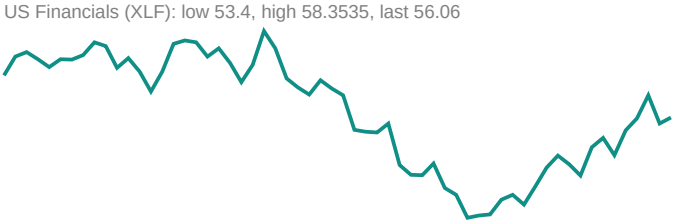


Brent crude: low 79.36, high 116.72, last 111.42



Gold: low 4007.9, high 4697.8, last 4035.7



Bitcoin: low 75612.5, high 86602.9, last 80372.3

US Financials (XLF): low 53.4, high 58.3535, last 56.06